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Hiring Manager

Coles Group Graduate Program

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to express my interest in the Coles Group Technology Graduate Program. I am in my final semester of a Bachelor of Information Technology (Enterprise Software Development) at RMIT, graduating in July 2026, and I am excited by the opportunity to contribute to a large, customer-focused organisation while growing my skills across software engineering, cloud, data and DevOps.

In my final-year project, I am enhancing an internal reporting tool by designing and implementing an automated test suite and improving the deployment pipeline using technologies such as EC2, S3, Bedrock and Docker. This has given me hands-on experience with production-adjacent systems, reliability and automation – skills that align closely with Coles Technology's focus on scalable, resilient platforms.

Outside formal coursework, I have been building a strong technical foundation. I have learnt tooling to manage environments across MacOS, Raspberry Pi and Windows desktop systems. I have experience with relational and NoSQL databases (MySQL, SQL Server, SQLite, MongoDB), object-oriented programming in Java and Python, and Linux-centric workflows (Git CLI, NixOS, Helix, shell scripting). I am particularly interested in how Coles applies cloud, data and AI/gen AI in large-scale retail systems.

I care strongly about people and culture. My strong academic performance got me selected for the RMIT student mentor program. I supported and mentored students with coursework questions. I've developed skills in triaging issues, working with learners at different levels, and creating a non-judgemental, supportive environment. Previously, I have worked as a chef for three years, where I learned to thrive in fast-paced, high-pressure environments, collaborate in tightly knit teams and resolve conflict constructively.

I heard about Coles' graduate program from a friend at Confluent. The structure of the Technology Graduate Program - rotations, a tailored development program and the Innovation Project - aligns with my goal of building a broad, solid Dev/Ops foundation while making a tangible impact solving actual business problems in ecommerce.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to bring my technical skills, mentoring experience and collaborative mindset to Coles Group as a Technology Graduate, and to grow my career while helping deliver better everyday experiences for your customers.

Yours sincerely,

Lachlan Deck